

SECTION 1 — IMPORT-READY SOURCE FILE

AP U.S. History Free-Response Practice Exam 11

APUSH-SAQ11-001

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 6 — Period 6: 1865–1898

Period: Period 6: 1865–1898

Theme: WXT — Work, Exchange, and Technology

Historical Reasoning: Comparison

Source Type: Secondary text source

Prompt:

Source A: Original secondary interpretation written for this practice exam, not an actual quotation. A historian of the post-Reconstruction South argues that the idea of a “New South” reflected genuine economic change. According to this interpretation, textile mills, tobacco factories, iron and steel production, railroad construction, and urban growth showed that some southern leaders sought to move beyond the plantation economy.

Source B: Original secondary interpretation written for this practice exam, not an actual quotation. A historian of southern society argues that the “New South” remained limited by older patterns of racial hierarchy, low wages, rural poverty, and dependence on outside capital. According to this interpretation, industrial growth did not fundamentally overturn the region’s unequal social and economic order.

- (a) Describe one major difference between the two interpretations of the “New South.”
- (b) Explain one piece of historical evidence that supports the argument in Source A.
- (c) Explain one piece of historical evidence that supports the argument in Source B.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Describes a valid difference, such as Source A emphasizing industrialization and modernization while Source B emphasizes continuity in racial hierarchy, poverty, low wages, outside investment, or limited economic transformation.
- (b) 1 point: Explains relevant evidence supporting Source A, such as textile mills in the Carolinas, Birmingham iron and steel, tobacco manufacturing, railroad expansion, urban growth in Atlanta, or business leaders promoting industrial development.
- (c) 1 point: Explains relevant evidence supporting Source B, such as Jim Crow segregation, disfranchisement, convict leasing, low-wage mill labor, rural poverty, crop-lien debt, dependence on northern capital, or limited opportunities for Black southerners.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should treat the “New South” as both a real economic slogan and a contested historical development. It should explain how industrial growth changed parts of the region while older racial, labor, and class structures limited the depth of that change.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-SAQ11-002

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 3 — Period 3: 1754–1800

Period: Period 3: 1754–1800

Theme: PCE — Politics and Power

Historical Reasoning: Sourcing / POV / Purpose / Audience

Source Type: Primary text source

Prompt:

Source: Original simulated source based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

A western Pennsylvania farmer and small distiller writing to a neighbor, 1794.

“The men in Philadelphia say the excise is lawful, but they do not haul grain over mountain roads or turn rye into whiskey because no buyer comes for loose bushels. The tax collector sees a still and thinks it a luxury. We see a way to pay debts, buy salt, and keep a farm alive. If liberty means anything after the Revolution, must distant officers know our hardship before they command our obedience?”

- (a) Identify one historical development that shaped the situation described in the source.
- (b) Explain how the author’s point of view likely influenced the argument made in the source.
- (c) Explain one way the situation described in the source reflected broader debates about federal authority in the early republic.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Identifies a relevant development, such as the Whiskey Rebellion, Hamilton’s financial program, the federal excise tax on distilled spirits, post-Revolutionary debt, western farmers’ economic grievances, or federal efforts to enforce national law.
- (b) 1 point: Explains that the author’s point of view as a western farmer and small distiller shaped the argument by emphasizing distance from eastern political power, transportation problems, debt, rural hardship, and suspicion of federal taxation.
- (c) 1 point: Explains a broader debate, such as conflict over federal taxation, the meaning of republican liberty, enforcement of national law, western resentment of eastern elites, Hamiltonian economic policy, or the power of the new federal government to suppress resistance.

Model Guidance:

A strong response should connect the source to early republic debates over taxation and federal authority. It should avoid treating the rebellion only as lawlessness and should explain how geography, debt, market access, and memories of the Revolution shaped resistance.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-SAQ11-003

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 8 — Period 8: 1945–1980

Period: Period 8: 1945–1980

Theme: WOR — America in the World

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Non-text source

Prompt:

Source: Described chart created for this practice exam.

The chart is titled “Science, Education, and the Space Race, 1957–1975.”

Indicator | 1957 | 1965 | 1975

Public concern about Soviet scientific achievement | sharply increased after Sputnik | still significant | lower but still present

Federal spending on space exploration | limited before Sputnik | very high during Apollo program | reduced after lunar missions

Federal support for math, science, and language education | expanded after 1958 | continued through Cold War programs | institutionalized in many schools and universities

Common public symbols | satellite fear, classroom science kits | astronauts, rockets, televised launches | space technology, computers, research laboratories

The chart notes that the figures are approximate and are intended to show broad historical trends.

(a) Describe one change in American society or government reflected in the chart.

(b) Explain one Cold War factor that contributed to the change described in part (a).

(c) Explain one consequence of the changes reflected in the chart for American education, technology, or national identity.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

(a) 1 point: Describes a valid change, such as expanded federal support for science education, increased space spending, greater public concern about Soviet technology, or the growth of scientific and technological institutions.

(b) 1 point: Explains a relevant Cold War factor, such as Sputnik, nuclear competition, military technology, rivalry with the Soviet Union, fears of falling behind in science, or the use of space achievement as a symbol of ideological competition.

(c) 1 point: Explains a relevant consequence, such as increased math and science education, growth of NASA, expansion of research universities, technological innovation, national pride after Apollo, military-industrial research, or greater federal influence in education and scientific research.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should connect the space race to Cold War competition and domestic change. It should avoid treating space exploration only as scientific curiosity and should explain how national security, education, technology, and identity were connected.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-DBQ11-001

Section: DBQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 9 — Period 9: 1980–Present

Period: Period 9: 1980–Present

Theme: GEO — Geography and the Environment

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Seven-document set

Prompt:

Evaluate the extent to which Hurricane Katrina revealed problems in American government, infrastructure, and social inequality in 2005 and its aftermath.

Document 1

Author/Origin: Described flood and levee map created for this practice exam, New Orleans region, 2005.

Source Type: Described map.

The map shows areas of New Orleans below sea level, major levee and floodwall breaches, neighborhoods with severe flooding, evacuation routes, and shelters of last resort. The deepest flooding appears in several low-lying neighborhoods with high rates of poverty. The map also shows major highways leaving the city and notes that many residents without cars could not easily evacuate.

Sourcing Cues: The map connects geography, infrastructure, transportation access, and neighborhood inequality.

Document 2

Author/Origin: Original simulated diary entry from a New Orleans resident sheltering in the city, September 2005; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Primary text source.

“The water came faster than anyone on our block expected. My mother’s medicine is gone, and the buses did not come before the storm. On television they ask why people stayed, as if everyone had a car, money for a hotel, or family in another state. Waiting for help feels like being blamed for needing it.”

Sourcing Cues: The diary reflects the perspective of a resident facing evacuation barriers, health needs, poverty, and public judgment.

Document 3

Author/Origin: Summary of emergency-management communications among local, state, and federal officials, Louisiana and Washington, D.C., 2005.

Source Type: Government communications summary.

The communications show confusion over who had authority to request, direct, and deliver emergency aid. Local officials emphasized immediate rescue needs, state officials requested federal assistance, and federal officials cited procedures, chain of command, and uncertainty about conditions on the ground. Critics later argued that delays reflected weak coordination before and after the storm.

Sourcing Cues: The summary reflects federalism, bureaucratic coordination problems, and disputes over responsibility during crisis.

Document 4

Author/Origin: Evacuation and displacement data table created for this practice exam, Gulf Coast, 2005–2006.

Source Type: Data table.

The table is titled “Selected Katrina Displacement Patterns.”

Group or condition | Common pattern after Katrina

Residents with cars and savings | more likely to evacuate before landfall and stay with relatives or in hotels

Residents without cars | more likely to rely on public shelters or delayed evacuation

Elderly and medically vulnerable residents | faced greater risk during evacuation and sheltering

Low-income renters | more likely to face long-term displacement and difficulty returning

Homeowners with insurance | more likely to rebuild, though recovery varied by neighborhood

A note beneath the table states: “Displacement and recovery were shaped by income, age, health, housing status, insurance, and transportation access.”

Sourcing Cues: The table emphasizes unequal vulnerability and recovery.

Document 5

Author/Origin: Original simulated editorial from a national newspaper, September 2005; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Newspaper-style editorial excerpt.

“The storm was natural, but the disaster was also political. Levees, wetlands, evacuation plans, poverty, public housing, and emergency agencies are human systems. When those systems fail, the question is not only why the hurricane came, but why so many citizens were left with so few choices.”

Sourcing Cues: The editorial reflects a national media argument linking environmental disaster to policy, infrastructure, and inequality.

Document 6

Author/Origin: Original simulated statement from a Gulf Coast business association, Louisiana, 2006; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Business association statement.

“Rebuilding requires ports, tourism, energy facilities, roads, and reliable flood protection. Federal aid must arrive quickly enough for businesses to reopen and workers to return. Yet recovery plans that ignore schools, housing, and neighborhood services will rebuild an economy without rebuilding the communities that sustain it.”

Sourcing Cues: The statement reflects business and regional economic concerns while acknowledging community recovery needs.

Document 7

Author/Origin: Original simulated testimony from a neighborhood recovery coalition, New Orleans, 2007; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Community organization testimony.

“Recovery meetings are held downtown while displaced residents are scattered across Houston, Atlanta, Baton Rouge, and beyond. Plans are drawn for neighborhoods whose people have not been given a real way to return. Rebuilding must include affordable housing, levee safety, schools, hospitals, and the voices of those who lived here before the water.”

Sourcing Cues: The testimony reflects grassroots criticism of unequal recovery, displacement, and exclusion from planning.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 7

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point for a historically defensible claim evaluating the extent to which Hurricane Katrina revealed problems in American government, infrastructure, and social inequality. The thesis must make an argument, such as that Katrina revealed deep problems in emergency federalism, aging infrastructure, urban poverty, racial and class inequality, and uneven recovery, while also showing that disaster effects were shaped by policy choices rather than nature alone.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing broader relevant context, such as late twentieth-century urban inequality, debates over federal and state responsibility, public infrastructure investment, coastal development, environmental vulnerability, poverty, racial segregation, emergency management after September 11, or shrinking public services in many cities.

Evidence from the Documents — 2 points: Earns 1 point for accurately using content from at least

three documents to address the prompt. Earns 2 points for using content from at least six documents to support a coherent argument about levees, evacuation access, poverty, emergency coordination, displacement, media criticism, regional economy, or community recovery.

Evidence Beyond the Documents — 1 point: Earns the point for using at least one specific, relevant piece of outside evidence not found in the documents, such as FEMA criticism, Superdome and Convention Center conditions, Army Corps of Engineers levee issues, environmental loss of wetlands, racial segregation in New Orleans, Road Home rebuilding program, debates over public housing demolition, or long-term displacement to Houston and other cities.

Sourcing / Analysis of Documents — 1 point: Earns the point by explaining how or why the point of view, purpose, audience, or historical situation of at least three documents is relevant to the argument. For example, a student might analyze the resident diary's challenge to victim-blaming narratives, the government summary's federalism problem, the data table's emphasis on unequal vulnerability, the newspaper editorial's policy critique, the business statement's economic recovery concerns, or the neighborhood testimony's grassroots demand for participation.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by demonstrating a nuanced argument, such as explaining that Katrina was both a natural hazard and a human-made disaster; distinguishing immediate emergency failures from long-term recovery inequalities; comparing local, state, and federal responsibilities; or showing how race, class, age, health, infrastructure, and geography interacted.

Model Guidance:

A strong DBQ would likely argue that Hurricane Katrina revealed severe weaknesses in emergency coordination, levee infrastructure, evacuation planning, and long-term urban inequality. Effective responses should avoid treating the hurricane as only a natural event. Useful document groupings include geography and infrastructure, evacuation barriers, federalism and bureaucratic delay, unequal displacement, media criticism, business recovery, and grassroots demands for inclusive rebuilding. Relevant outside evidence could include FEMA, Superdome conditions, Army Corps levee failures, wetlands loss, public housing debates, the Road Home program, or long-term displacement of New Orleans residents.

Expected Points:

7

APUSH-LEQ11-001

Section: LEQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 4 — Period 4: 1800–1848

Period: Cross-Period / Thematic

Theme: NAT — American and National Identity

Historical Reasoning: Continuity and Change Over Time

Source Type: Broad historical prompt with introductory statement

Prompt:

The War of 1812 and its aftermath shaped debates over national identity, economic development, federal policy, regional interests, and the United States' place in North America. Students may choose to focus on developments such as wartime mobilization, the Hartford Convention, the collapse of the Federalist Party, the "Era of Good Feelings," the American System, tariffs, internal improvements, the Second Bank of the United States, or growing regional disagreements.

Evaluate the extent to which the War of 1812 and its aftermath changed American national identity and federal policy from 1800 to 1848.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 6

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point for a historically defensible thesis that evaluates the

extent to which the War of 1812 and its aftermath changed American national identity and federal policy from 1800 to 1848. The thesis must make an argument about continuity, change, or both.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing broader context relevant to the War of 1812 and early nineteenth-century nationalism, such as conflicts with Britain and France, impressment, frontier conflict, Jeffersonian Republicanism, commercial restrictions, regional divisions, early industrial growth, or post-Revolutionary uncertainty about national unity.

Evidence — 2 points: Earns 1 point for identifying at least two specific pieces of relevant evidence, such as the War of 1812, Battle of New Orleans, Hartford Convention, collapse of the Federalist Party, Era of Good Feelings, American System, Henry Clay, protective tariffs, internal improvements, Second Bank of the United States, *McCulloch v. Maryland*, Monroe Doctrine, or regional debates over federal spending. Earns 2 points for using at least two pieces of evidence to support an argument about change and continuity.

Historical Reasoning — 1 point: Earns the point by explaining continuity and change over time, such as showing how the war encouraged nationalism, economic self-sufficiency, and federal support for development while older conflicts over regional interest, constitutional interpretation, and federal power continued.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by developing a nuanced argument, such as explaining that nationalism grew after the war but remained fragile; distinguishing cultural nationalism from economic policy; showing how policies meant to unite the nation produced sectional disagreement; or explaining that Republicans adopted some policies once associated with Federalists while continuing to debate federal power.

Model Guidance:

A strong LEQ should explain how the War of 1812 and its aftermath influenced national identity and federal policy rather than simply narrating the war. Strong responses might argue that the war encouraged a stronger sense of nationalism and support for economic development through tariffs, banking, and internal improvements, but that sectional tensions and constitutional disagreements persisted. Effective evidence could include the Hartford Convention, the Battle of New Orleans, the American System, the Second Bank, *McCulloch v. Maryland*, the Era of Good Feelings, and debates over internal improvements.

Expected Points:

6

SECTION 2 — SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — DO NOT IMPORT

SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — APUSH-FRQ11

· APUSH-SAQ11-001: Unit 6; Period 6: 1865–1898; perspectives include modern secondary historians of the New South as industrial modernization and the New South as continuity in racial/economic hierarchy; source type is paired secondary text interpretations; source viewpoints contrast textile, tobacco, steel, railroad, and urban growth with Jim Crow, disfranchisement, low wages, rural poverty, outside capital, and convict leasing; historical development is New South industrialization and limits of post-Reconstruction economic transformation; reasoning path is comparison; misconception targeted is treating the New South as either complete modernization or complete continuity without evaluating both change and limits.

· APUSH-SAQ11-002: Unit 3; Period 3: 1754–1800; perspective is western Pennsylvania farmer and small distiller during the Whiskey Rebellion; source type is original simulated primary text; source viewpoint emphasizes rural hardship, transportation barriers, whiskey as marketable grain, debt, distance from eastern political power, and suspicion of excise taxation; historical development is Whiskey Rebellion, Hamiltonian finance, federal excise taxation, and early republic enforcement of national law; reasoning path is POV/purpose/audience connected to federal authority, taxation,

geography, debt, and revolutionary memory; misconception targeted is treating the Whiskey Rebellion only as disorder rather than a conflict over markets, taxation, and the meaning of republican liberty.

· APUSH-SAQ11-003: Unit 8; Period 8: 1945–1980; perspectives include federal officials, scientists, students, teachers, universities, defense planners, NASA, and the public watching Cold War competition; non-text source type is plain-text science/space race chart; visual/data/map pattern is post-Sputnik concern, federal space spending, math/science/language education, astronauts, rockets, classroom science kits, computers, and laboratories; historical development is Sputnik, Cold War science education, NASA, Apollo program, and federal support for research and technology; reasoning path is causation linking Cold War rivalry, national security, education, technology, and national identity; misconception targeted is treating the space race as only exploration rather than a Cold War-driven transformation of education, research, and federal science policy.

· APUSH-DBQ11-001: Unit 9; Period 9: 1980–Present; DBQ topic is Hurricane Katrina revealing problems in American government, infrastructure, and social inequality in 2005 and its aftermath; document types include described flood/levee map, resident diary, emergency-management communications summary, evacuation/displacement data table, national newspaper editorial, Gulf Coast business association statement, and neighborhood recovery coalition testimony; document perspectives include low-income residents, medically vulnerable residents, local/state/federal officials, national media, business leaders, displaced renters/homeowners, recovery planners, and neighborhood activists; main argument paths include levee and infrastructure failure, evacuation inequality, federalism and bureaucratic delay, poverty and racial/class inequality, media criticism, economic rebuilding, long-term displacement, and grassroots demands for inclusive recovery; outside evidence possibilities include FEMA criticism, Superdome and Convention Center conditions, Army Corps of Engineers levee issues, wetlands loss, racial segregation in New Orleans, Road Home program, public housing demolition debates, and long-term displacement to Houston and other cities; sourcing opportunities include resident diary against victim-blaming, government summary on federalism, data table on unequal vulnerability, newspaper editorial's policy critique, business association's regional economy focus, and neighborhood testimony's grassroots recovery perspective; visual/data/map types include described flood/levee map and evacuation/displacement data table.

· APUSH-LEQ11-001: Units 4–5; Periods 4–5 / Cross-Period; LEQ topic is the War of 1812 and its aftermath changing American national identity and federal policy from 1800 to 1848; historical reasoning process is continuity and change over time; evidence categories include War of 1812, Battle of New Orleans, Hartford Convention, collapse of Federalist Party, Era of Good Feelings, American System, Henry Clay, protective tariffs, internal improvements, Second Bank of the United States, *McCulloch v. Maryland*, Monroe Doctrine, and regional debates over federal spending; complexity path is distinguishing cultural nationalism from economic policy, showing Republicans adopting some Federalist-style policies, and explaining that nationalism grew while constitutional and sectional conflict persisted; misconception targeted is treating the War of 1812 as militarily isolated rather than as a catalyst for nationalism, economic policy debates, and unresolved regional tensions.